



Fulfilling Orders

If your business sells and delivers products, it is vital to develop an efficient system for fulfilling customer orders. Customers will value your reliability, and your brand will inspire trust.

Meeting expectations

Over the past decade, advances in managing orders from sale to delivery have raised customer expectations of quick, convenient receipt of goods and their easy return. A positive experience at each stage strongly influences customers' purchasing behavior, so a new retail venture needs to

ensure that each part of the process, from taking orders and packing goods to sending them out, is as fast and efficient as possible.

To facilitate this, make sure you have sufficient stock, stored as close to your premises as possible, so that products can be easily accessed, packed, and dispatched. Keep careful records throughout.

Initially, you might use multiple spreadsheets to track incoming orders and costs, to review and update inventory, and to set delivery dates so customers know when to expect their goods. As your online orders grow, however, you are likely to need order fulfillment software to help you organize your systems—or you may

Managing the process

A basic fulfillment system should enable you to handle orders promptly, acknowledge receipt of them, keep a record of them manually or otherwise, and communicate with all parties involved—from the manufacturer to the customer. Keeping track of all your inventory (products and materials) is also crucial so that you have what is needed to meet demand. Coordinate each stage with the next one to ensure a smooth process.



Take orders

When a customer places an order, check whether the goods are in stock or when they will be available. When this is confirmed, send an email to the customer, supplying them with an order number and indicating an estimated delivery date.



Manufacture or retrieve the product

Create the product or retrieve it from existing stock, simultaneously updating the inventory and creating or ordering more items to meet future demand. Then carefully package, label, and prepare the package for dispatch.